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Ganesh Chaturthi

—◆ Puja Guide ◆—

✦ Complete Information About Ganesh Chaturthi ✦





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How to Make Ganesh Chaturthi Truly Special

Ganesh Chaturthi celebrates the birth of Lord Ganesha, the remover of obstacles and god of wisdom, on Chaturthi Tithi of Shukla Paksha in the Bhadrapada month. Families welcome Bappa home with a beautifully decorated idol, daily aarti, and modak offerings, before a grand farewell on Visarjan day. Sri Mandir brings you this complete guide to dates, samagri, rituals, and mantras so you can celebrate with full devotion.





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Table of Contents



1. When is Ganesh Chaturthi 2026?	1
2. Sthapana & Visarjan Muhurat	1
3. Significance of Ganesh Chaturthi	2
4. How to Perform Ganesh Sthapana at Home ---	2
5. Essential Puja Samagri List	3
6. Daily Puja & Aarti Routine	4
7. Modak: Bappa's Favorite Bhog	4
8. Dos and Don'ts	5
9. Visarjan Vidhi	6
10. Aarti	7-8
11. FAQs	9





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When is Ganesh Chaturthi 2026?

Auspicious Date & Time

✿ Date:	Monday, 14 September 2026
✿ Chaturthi Tithi Begins:	07:06 AM, 14 September
✿ Chaturthi Tithi Ends:	07:44 AM, 15 September
✿ Sthapana Muhurat (Madhyahna):	11:02 AM to 1:31 PM, 14 September (New Delhi)

Visarjan Options (Choose as per family tradition)

✿ 1.5 Days:	15 September
✿ 3 Days:	16 September
✿ 5 Days:	18 September
✿ 7 Days:	20 September
✿ Main Visarjan (Anant Chaturdashi):	Friday, 25 September 2026





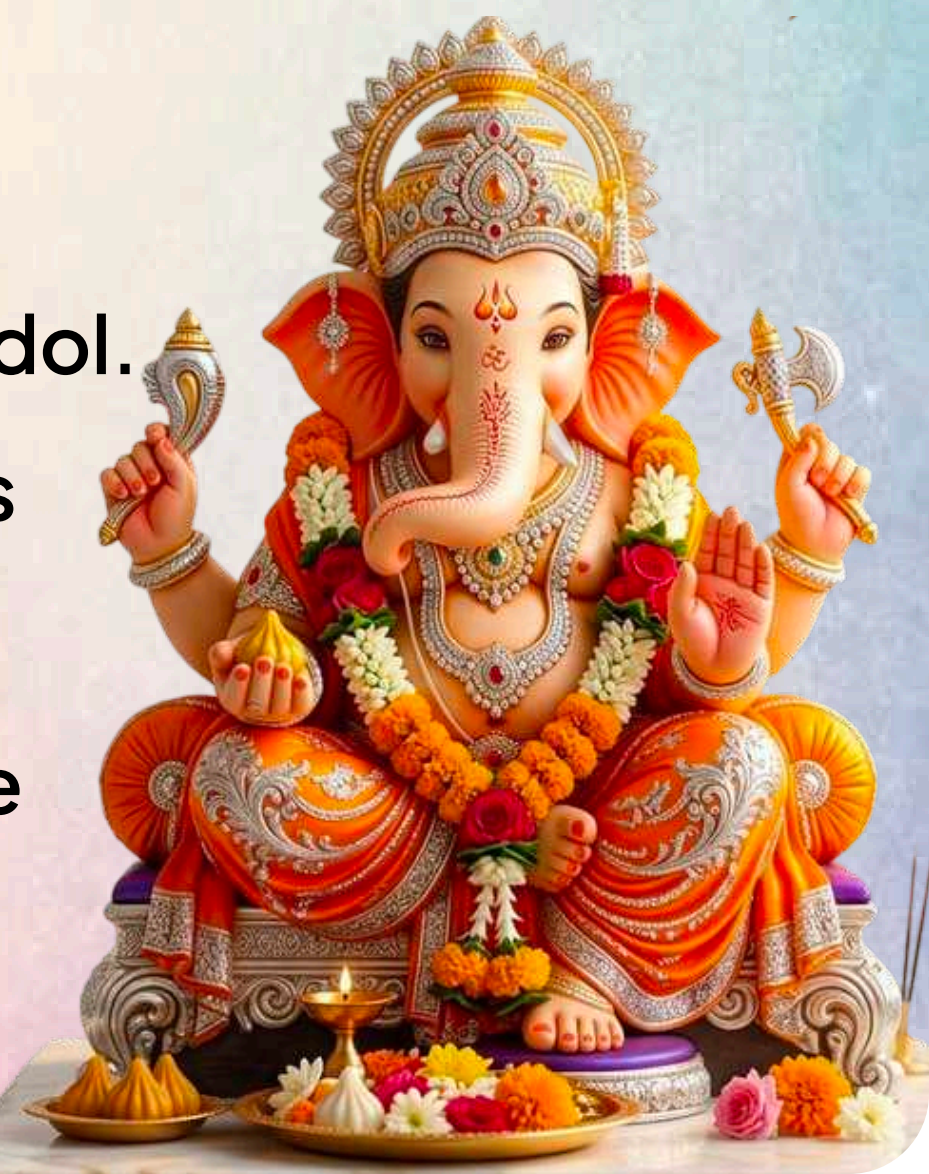
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Significance of Ganesh Chaturthi

Lord Ganesha is worshipped first before any ritual or new beginning, as he is the remover of obstacles (Vighnaharta) and the god of wisdom. His arrival is celebrated with joy as an honoured guest; daily worship, bhog, and aarti mark his stay before he departs with the promise to return. Popularized as a public festival by Lokmanya Tilak, Ganeshotsav today unites communities in shared devotion and celebration.

How to Perform Ganesh Sthapana at Home

1. Clean the puja space & decorate the spot.
2. Enshrine the idol on a raised platform facing East or North.
3. Place the Kalash beside the idol with mango leaves & coconut.
4. Invoke Lord Ganesha with Sthapana mantras during Madhyahna Muhurat.
5. Offer Durva grass, flowers, and akshat.
6. Apply chandan and kumkum tilak to the idol.
7. Perform the aarti first and offer modak as bhog.
8. Light incense and dhoop to complete the ritual.





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Essential Puja Samagri List

1. Idol & Altar

- Ganesha idol (clay/eco-friendly preferred)
- Wooden platform or decorated mandap
- Red or yellow cloth



2. Worship Items

- Kalash with water, mango leaves, coconut
- Panchamrit (milk, curd, ghee, honey, sugar)
- Chandan, kumkum, akshat (rice)
- Durva grass (mandatory offering)
- Flowers and garlands



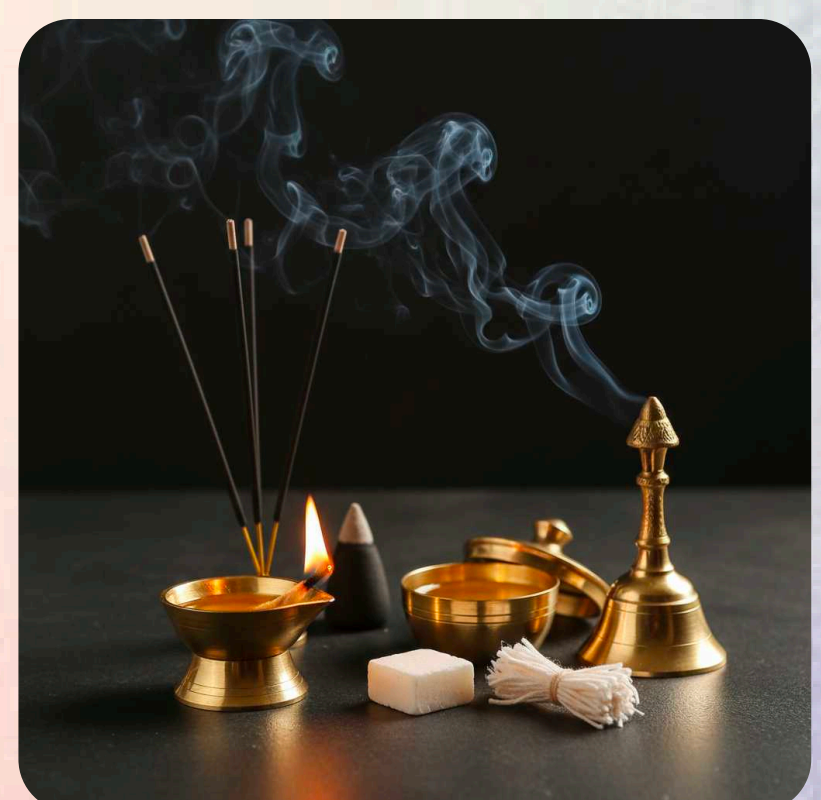
3. Bhog

- Modak, laddoo, or seasonal sweets
- Coconut and fruits



4. Puja & Lamp

- Incense sticks, camphor, dhoop
- Diya, ghee/oil, cotton wick
- Bell for aarti





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Daily Puja & Aarti Routine

- Perform morning and evening aarti each day Bappa is home.
- Offer fresh flowers and Durva grass daily.
- Offer modak or seasonal fruit as bhog.
- Chant "Om Gam Ganapataye Namah" during worship.
- Recite Ganesh Atharvashirsha or Ganesh Chalisa.
- Keep the altar clean and lamp lit through the day.

Daily Mantra

Om Gam Ganapataye Namah

Modak: Bappa's Favorite Bhog

Modak, a sweet dumpling made of rice flour or wheat, stuffed with jaggery and coconut, is Lord Ganesha's most beloved offering. Traditionally, 21 modaks are offered during the puja, symbolizing the fulfillment of wishes and complete devotion. Steamed (ukadiche modak) and fried varieties are both offered, based on regional tradition.





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Dos and Don'ts



What to Do

- ✓ Welcome Ganesha with joy and devotion
- ✓ Keep the puja space clean and peaceful
- ✓ Offer Durva grass to Ganesha daily
- ✓ Offer modak, laddoo, fruits, or other prasad
- ✓ Light a diya and incense during daily puja
- ✓ Perform Ganesh Aarti in the morning and evening
- ✓ Chant Ganesh mantras and pray with your family
- ✓ Perform Visarjan respectfully with proper rituals



What Not to Do

- ✗ Don't view the moon on Ganesh Chaturthi night, as advised in the traditional story
- ✗ Avoid non-vegetarian food and intoxicants during the festival
- ✗ Don't use Plaster of Paris or chemically painted idols
- ✗ Don't leave the puja area dirty or cluttered
- ✗ Don't offer Tulsi leaves to Ganesha
- ✗ Avoid arguments, anger, and harsh words during the festival
- ✗ Don't waste or disrespect prasad and other offerings
- ✗ Don't disrespect or handle the idol carelessly, especially during Visarjan



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Visarjan Vidhi

1. Perform a final aarti and offer naivedya
2. Seek forgiveness for any lapse in hospitality (Uttarpuja)
3. Carry the idol in procession with chants of "Ganpati Bappa Morya"
4. Immerse the idol in a water body, or a bucket/ tank at home for eco-friendly immersion
5. Bid farewell with: "Ganpati Bappa Morya, Pudhchya Varshi Lavkar Ya" (Come again soon, next year)





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Aarti

Sri Ganesh Aarti

Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh Deva,
Mata Jaki Parvati, Pita Mahadeva ॥

Ek dant Dayavant, Chaar Bhuja Dhari,
Mathe Par Tilak Sohe, Muse Ki Sawari ॥
Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh Deva...

Paan Chadhe Phool Chadhe, Aur Chadhe Meva,
Ladduan Ka Bhog Lage, Sant Kare Sewa ॥
Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh Deva...

Andhan Ko Aankh Det, Kodhin Ko Kaya,
Baanjhan Ko Putra Det, Nirdhan Ko Maya ॥
Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh Deva...

"Sur" Shyam Sharan Aaye, Safal Kije Seva,
Mata Jaki Parvati, Pita Mahadeva ॥
Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh, Jai Ganesh Deva,
Mata Jaki Parvati, Pita Mahadeva ॥



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Sukhkarta Dukhharta Aarti

Sukhkarta Dukhharta, Varta Vighnachi,
Nurvi Purvi Prem, Krupa Jayachi ।
Sarvangi Sundar, Uti Shendurachi,
Kanthi Zalke Mal, Muktaphalachi ॥

Jai Dev Jai Dev, Jai Mangal Murti,
Darshan Matre Man, Kamana Purti ॥ Jai Dev
Jai Dev...

Ratnakhachit Phara, Tuja Gauri Kumara,
Chandanachi Uti, Kumkum Kesara ।
Hire Jadit Mukut, Shobhato Bara,
Runjhunti Nupure, Charani Ghagariya ॥

Jai Dev Jai Dev, Jai Mangal Murti...

Lambodar Pitambar, Phanivar Vandana,
Saral Sond Vakratunda, Trinayana ।
Das Ramacha Vat, Pahe Sadana,
Sankashti Pavave, Nirvani Rakshave, Suravar
Vandana ॥

Jai Dev Jai Dev, Jai Mangal Murti,
Darshan Matre Man, Kamana Purti ॥



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Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q. Why shouldn't we see the moon on Ganesh Chaturthi?

According to legend, viewing the moon this night invites false blame or slander (as happened to Lord Krishna); devotees avoid it as a precaution.

Q. How many days can Ganpati be kept at home?

Families keep Ganpati for 1.5, 3, 5, 7, or 10 days, based on personal or family tradition; all durations are equally valid.

Q. Why is Durva grass offered to Ganesha?

Durva grass is considered Lord Ganesha's favorite offering, symbolizing humility and purity, believed to please him quickly.

Q. What does "Ganpati Bappa Morya" mean?

"Bappa" means revered father, and "Morya" honors a 15th-century devotee whose devotion became eternally linked with Ganesha's name, an affectionate chant of welcome and farewell.

Q. Can eco-friendly idols be immersed at home?

Yes, clay idols dissolve safely in a bucket or tank at home, honoring both Ganesha and the environment.



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